

flexible work culture in my department. The faculty is free to collaborate with the industry, spend time there and keep themselves updated.

If this kind of flexibility is given, teachers can create wonders, and the students taught by them will create wonders! To empower academia, the government policies even encourage faculty members to open their startups.

Being a polytechnic college, we used to find it very difficult to get the industry to collaborate with our faculty members. But that has improved, and industry folks are open to giving us projects where we can work and deliver. The only way to grow the electronics industry and ensure the development of academia is if they work in tandem.

I was happy to see that the EFY Expo in Pune gave special privileges to people from academia. I see that you're trying to fill this gap as well and create a common platform. I'm a part of multiple groups created by EFY, and I get a lot of input from simple and informative discussions in the groups. Even the seminars and talks provide valuable input from academia to the industry, and vice versa. We need more such platforms.

How has the hiring scenario changed after the introduction of policies such as Make in India and Startup India?

A lot of startups have come up and they are always looking for fresh talent. They are also very comfortable in giving students internships. They recruit students from the colleges as interns and freshers. In turn, they provide these students with relevant industry experience, which is a win-win for both. So, government policies such as Startup India or Make in India have opened the industry doors for students.

There is another benefit to these policies as students now want to

build their startups, since lot of incentives are given for startups. The competitive spirit of the students is also going up along with innovative thinking, which is a big achievement if you compare it with the number of jobs that have been created by these policies. Not everybody can be a successful entrepreneur, but even if the students are thinking along those lines, it shows how these policies have supported and encouraged the entrepreneurial spirit.

Why don't we see many women-led startups in the electronics industry?

Apart from the holdback because of culture, it is also the lack of risk-taking ability that could be an answer to your question. The risk-taking ability needs to be encouraged. While a job gives a graduate a sense of security, startups don't necessarily offer that.

Thankfully, due to various government schemes and incentives, that is gradually changing. As a part of our coursework, we have subjects related to entrepreneurship and innovation. The risk-taking ability can only be developed if the students are confident about the support offered by family and society, as well as teachers.

What are the novel research projects and innovations that are currently ongoing at SNTD in the ESDM sector?

At the degree level, we have courses related to computer science and data science as well. We have collaborated with a public university in New York that has a weather station installed which collects weather-related data. Our students utilise this data for analytics and are coming up with interesting projects. Our faculty members are involved in different projects related to power electronics, IoT, and communication networks. **EFY**



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